

Yami Gopal

Engineer Turned Talent Partner

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SUMMARY

Engineer with 20 years of hands-on technical experience who has spent the last decade coaching, evaluating, and building engineering teams. As an agile coach I worked inside squads at companies like FlixBus, John Deere, and Boehringer Ingelheim, where I learned to read engineers quickly: who has real depth, who ships, who leads under pressure, and who lifts the people around them. Before that I spent ten years as a senior technical lead at Disney, FedEx, and Ingram Micro, building backend systems and leading engineering teams. I still build production software today at my own studio in Berlin, so I can evaluate builders from a place of genuine technical fluency, not just pattern matching on resumes.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer — Berlin AI Labs

2022 – Present · Berlin, Germany

Running a small studio where I solo-build production software. This keeps my technical skills current and gives me firsthand understanding of what it takes to ship real products as a builder.

- Built and shipped 9 production systems across TypeScript, Python, React, and Node.js
- Published an open-source security tool to npm used by the developer community
- Operate within the Berlin builder and startup ecosystem, attending hackathons and community events
- Deeply familiar with the European AI and deep-tech landscape, including companies like Lovable, ElevenLabs, and the broader Berlin startup scene

Agile Coach & Engineering Team Evaluator

2012 – 2022 · Boehringer Ingelheim, FlixBus, John Deere, Yara International

Spent ten years embedded inside engineering teams across pharma, mobility, agriculture, and logistics. My daily work was understanding engineers: assessing their strengths, identifying gaps in teams, matching people to the right roles, and coaching them to grow.

- Evaluated and coached hundreds of engineers across 10+ organizations, learning to assess technical depth and cultural fit quickly
- Helped hiring managers define what "good" looks like for their specific team context, going beyond resumes to understand builder potential
- Matched engineers to roles within cross-functional teams based on their technical strengths, working style, and growth trajectory
- Facilitated team formation during reorganizations, ensuring the right mix of skills and personalities for each squad
- Coached product owners and engineering leads on building high-performing teams, not just hiring individuals

- Worked across cultures and countries (Germany, India, USA, Norway) with a natural ability to connect with technical people from diverse backgrounds

Senior Technical Lead & Software Engineer

2002 – 2012 · The Walt Disney Company, FedEx, Ingram Micro

Ten years building enterprise software and leading engineering teams gave me the technical foundation to credibly evaluate other engineers.

- Led engineering teams of 5 to 15 people, responsible for technical hiring, code reviews, and career development
- Built backend systems, APIs, and data pipelines at scale for Fortune 500 companies
- Mentored junior and mid-level engineers, many of whom went on to senior and lead roles
- Developed an intuition for what separates a good engineer from a great one: not just technical skill, but ownership, curiosity, and the ability to ship

WHAT I BRING TO THIS ROLE

Technical Fluency: I still write code daily. I can assess an engineer's depth in a real conversation, not just by scanning their GitHub.

Network: Embedded in the Berlin builder ecosystem through my studio, community events, hackathons, and the broader European AI scene.

Talent Eye: Ten years of coaching taught me to see past resumes. I know how to spot builders who ship versus talkers who demo.

Cross-Cultural: Worked across India, USA, Germany, and Norway. Native English, German B2. Comfortable connecting with people from any background.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

M.Sc. Electrical Engineering — Tennessee Tech University, USA

B.E. Electrical Engineering — College of Engineering, Pune, India

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) · Certified Agile Leadership

English C2 (native) · German B2

WHY {TECH: EUROPE}

I have spent twenty years on both sides of this equation. I have been the engineer getting hired, the tech lead doing the hiring, and the coach helping teams figure out who they actually need. That combination is exactly what this role asks for. You are not looking for a recruiter. You are looking for someone who understands builders because they are one, and who can look at an engineer and see where they would thrive. That is what I have been doing for the last decade, and I would love to do it for the community you are building.